above deep-seated divisions of distrust and disharmony between the two countries, a chorus of voices cried out in a shrill slogan of, ‘Long live the memory of Bhagat Singh!’ on that Saturday evening. They had resolved against all adversity to commemorate the hanging to death on 23 March 1931 of these three iconic figures in Lahore Central Jail. Indeed, some years ago, oblivious to the importance of its preservation, a traffic roundabout christened Shadman Chowk was said to have sprung up at this very spot. Now, however, a motley of people young and old, in surprisingly large numbers, excitedly descended upon this very spot. They rushed to pay tributes to the hanged three, heedless of the impending wrath of the hard-line religious zealots objecting to the deification of individuals who were not Muslims. Nearly 200 km away too, in Banga village, near Faisalabad, where Bhagat Singh was born, there was reverence shown in remembrance of the ultimate sacrifices he made for the cause of freedom in what was then pre-Partition India.

The day of commemoration had been long planned and organized by the chairman of the Lahore-based Bhagat Singh Memorial Foundation, Imtiaz Rashid Qureshi, and his father Abdul Rashid Qureshi, both supreme court lawyers. At Shadman Chowk, bright white candles were lit as the sun set in the distant and the grey light of dusk fell upon the city and gave it its distinctive colour. Established and aspiring artists rose up to sing traditional Punjabi folk songs and verses in memory of the revolutionaries. Bhagat Singh was designated not only a martyr of India but of the whole subcontinent. In a telephone interview given to the *Times of India*, Imtiaz Qureshi explained, ‘We too have every right over the memory of Bhagat Singh as the freedom fighter was not only born in Pakistan, but had spent most of the time of his short but meaningful life at Lahore. We see him as an icon of struggle.’ He said about his objective, ‘We want Bhagat Singh to be treated as a freedom fighter in Pakistan and Shadman Chowk should be named after him.’ He saw nothing incongruous in the fact that Bhagat was not a Muslim because, the ‘Founder of Pakistan, Muhammad Ali Jinnah, had paid tributes to Bhagat Singh in Delhi assembly on September 4, 1929, and Bhagat Singh is a hero to many Pakistanis.’ Imtiaz Qureshi was not